FEDERAL MINISTRY OF
INDUSTRY, TRADE &
INVESTMENT

OFFICE OF THE HONOURABLE MINISTER

Accelerating Routes for Nigerian Exports into the AfCFTA

One Year of the Nigeria – East/Southern Africa Air Cargo Corridor
(May 2025 – May 2026)

In Partnership with Uganda Airlines and RwandAir

REPORT OF THE HONOURABLE MINISTER
FEDERAL MINISTRY OF INDUSTRY, TRADE AND INVESTMENT, NIGERIA

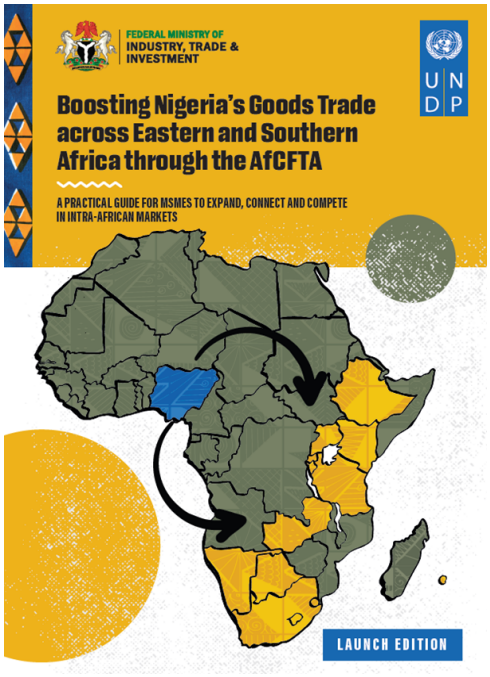
Dr. Jumoke Oduwole, MFR

A The Honourable Minister's Reflections

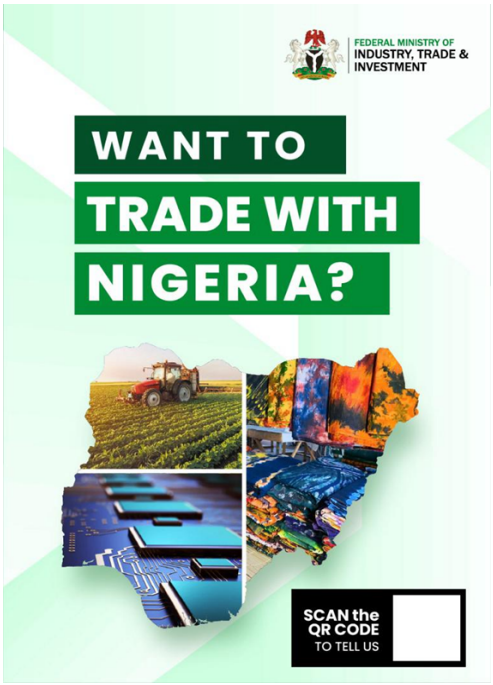
The African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) Agreement is Africa's instrument for trade-led integration. In 2025, the Federal Government of Nigeria, under the leadership of His Excellency, President Bola Ahmed Tinubu GCFR, took deliberate steps to translate the promise of the AfCFTA Agreement into beneficial commercial outcomes for Nigerian businesses.

The Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment (FMITI) inaugurated the AfCFTA Central Coordination Committee, a whole-of-economy body that brings together over twenty institutions across the public and private sectors to drive Nigeria's implementation efforts. FMITI also led the gazetting of Nigeria's Provisional Schedule of Tariff Concessions for Trade in Goods. In the same year, Nigeria became the first AfCFTA State Party to complete and publish the five-year review of implementation required under Article 28 of the Agreement.

To complement these policy and regulatory actions, FMITI embarked on an aggressive AfCFTA market scoping exercise at continental and regional levels. In May 2025, a market intelligence tool published in collaboration with UNDP Nigeria examined Nigeria's goods trade across 13 Eastern and Southern African markets, concentrating on three priority product categories: agro-processed products, cosmetics and beauty products, and textiles and fashion. The products examined account for hundreds of millions of dollars in imports each year, the greater part supplied from outside Africa, and much of it in goods that Nigeria already exports competitively to global markets. Similarly, at the Intra-African Trade Fair 2025 held in Algeria, the Nigeria team engaged in an intense marketing campaign, to understand demand for Nigerian products in other markets.



Market Intelligence Tool Published in 2025



Marketing Flyer at the Intra-African Trade Fair 2025

FMITI acted decisively to ensure that the lower tariffs available under the AfCFTA could translate into competitively priced exports for Nigerian businesses. A dedicated air cargo corridor was opened in 2025 with Uganda Airlines to carry Nigerian goods to East and Southern Africa via three destinations – Entebbe, Uganda; Nairobi, Kenya; and Johannesburg, South Africa. It was not a coincidence that the corridor was launched on Africa Day, 25 May 2025, when the continent commemorates the establishment of the Organisation of African Unity, now the African Union. This arrangement has reduced the cost of moving Nigerian goods to other regions, enhanced the competitiveness of Nigerian products in priority markets, and demonstrated that the AfCFTA can deliver tangible results for businesses.

Together, these efforts are yielding results. In 2024, Nigeria's total non-oil exports to 25 African countries outside the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) stood at $150 million . This increased to $207 million in 2025 across the same non-ECOWAS countries. This growth, together with market research and bilateral consultations with trade partners, pointed to the need to expand the corridor to additional destinations and to accommodate greater volumes of cargo.

In 2026, again on Africa Day, I am pleased to announce an arrangement with RwandAir to five destinations – Kigali, Rwanda; Nairobi, Kenya; Lusaka, Zambia; Harare, Zimbabwe; and Johannesburg, South Africa. This partnership will be formally flagged off in June 2026.

I am grateful to our partners, the Government of the Republic of Uganda and Uganda Airlines and the Government of the Republic Rwanda and RwandAir for their visionary collaboration, commitment to regional integration, and spirit of African solidarity.

I also extend my thanks to the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) Regional Bureau for Africa for the strategic and technical assistance that facilitated this corridor, from conception through consultations, negotiations and operationalisation. I especially thank Dr. Ify Ogo, Regional AfCFTA Coordination Specialist, and Dr. William Asiedu, Regional Research and Data Analyst (AfCFTA), for their technical efforts.

My sincere appreciation goes to all the Nigerian government institutions involved in establishing this corridor, including the Federal Ministry of Aviation and Aerospace Development, the Federal Airports Authority of Nigeria, the Nigeria Customs Service, and all agencies of the Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment. The Nigerian Export Promotion Council, in particular, deserves special commendation for its support to businesses exporting to the AfCFTA market.

This corridor was established and remains operational for the benefit of all Nigerian exporting businesses. Section B of this report presents the collaborative process that underpins the corridor, and Section C highlights key learnings and reflections. Section D concludes with key next steps for Nigeria in advancing the implementation of the AfCFTA for Nigerian businesses.

[1] All monetary amounts in this report are expressed in United States dollars (USD)

B Paving the Corridor

As part of a renewed effort to implement the AfCFTA, FMITI addressed a key obstacle faced by Nigerian goods exporters to East and Southern Africa: the cost of moving goods by air. Air cargo accommodates a wide range of shipment sizes and allows Nigerian businesses to respond quickly to consumer demand. Consultations with businesses and business associations found exporters paying between $5 and $7 per kilogramme, and in some cases above $10. At these rates, many Nigerian goods could not compete favourably in regional markets. In some cases, exporters relied on informal and high-risk channels to avoid high cargo costs.

FMITI's response was a dedicated air cargo corridor, negotiated with commercial airlines and grounded in the priorities of Nigerian businesses. The corridor opened in 2025 with Uganda Airlines and was extended in 2026 with RwandAir. Both arrangements are set out below.

1. 2026 – RWANDAIR

Under the direction of the Honourable Minister of Industry, Trade and Investment, FMITI commenced negotiations with RwandAir, conducted from April 2026 by Dr. Ify Ogo, Regional AfCFTA Specialist, UNDP, in collaboration with Patience Okala, National Coordinator, Nigeria AfCFTA Coordination Office, with the support of Dr. William Asiedu, Regional Research and Data Analyst (AfCFTA), UNDP, and Olayombo Ade-Ojo, Senior Special Assistant to the Honourable Minister on Trade Facilitation. This negotiation team was informed by consultations with the Nigerian Chamber of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture. The team also relied on insights from the framing of the air cargo corridor in 2025 and Nigeria's trade performance in the same period.

In May 2026, on the sidelines of the 13th Africa CEO Forum in Kigali, President Bola Ahmed Tinubu held bilateral talks with President Paul Kagame of Rwanda on deepening cooperation between Nigeria and Rwanda, including in trade. At this meeting, the Honourable Minister of Industry, Trade and Investment, Dr. Jumoke Oduwole advocated a partnership to move Nigerian goods into the AfCFTA market through RwandAir.

Following technical negotiations and political endorsement, RwandAir offered Nigerian exporters rebated rates from Lagos to Kigali, Johannesburg, Harare, Nairobi, and Lusaka, as set out below.

Table 1: Rebated rates offered by RwandAir to Nigerian businesses in 2026

Route	Minimum charge	Below 1,000 kg	Above 1,000 kg
Lagos to Kigali	$100	$1.40/kg	$1.20/kg
Lagos to Johannesburg	$120	$1.90/kg	$1.70/kg
Lagos to Harare	$110	$1.80/kg	$1.60/kg
Lagos to Nairobi	$100	$1.70/kg	$1.50/kg
Lagos to Lusaka	$110	$1.80/kg	$1.60/kg

A flat Airway Bill Fee of $15 applies to all destinations

The RwandAir arrangement extends the corridor in two respects. It opens Kigali, Harare, and Lusaka as new destinations, and it provides Nigerian exporters with a choice of carrier on the Nairobi and Johannesburg routes already served by Uganda Airlines.

2. 2025 – UGANDA AIRLINES

In March 2025, the UNDP Regional Bureau for Africa brought to the attention of the Honourable Minister of Industry, Trade and Investment the opportunity to explore a special cargo arrangement with Uganda Airlines, and broadly the opportunity to collaborate with the Republic of Uganda as an emerging distribution hub in the African market.

The Honourable Minister then directed the commencement of a public, open, and consultative engagement with Nigerian businesses. FMITI and UNDP convened a virtual inception meeting with Nigerian businesses and business associations, where Uganda Airlines presented its services, operational routes, and frequency, and proposed a variable cargo rate. This meeting also explored the opportunity for a specially negotiated arrangement with Uganda Airlines to serve all Nigerian businesses.

Flyer Announcing Consultations on the Uganda Airlines Arrangement

NDP, through the Regional AfCFTA Team provided technical assistance to the Nigerian government and business associations/businesses for cargo rate negotiations. This involved curating a robust dataset that captured the main products exported to the AfCFTA market, priority destinations, frequency, and value of exports, alongside prevailing commercial cargo rates.

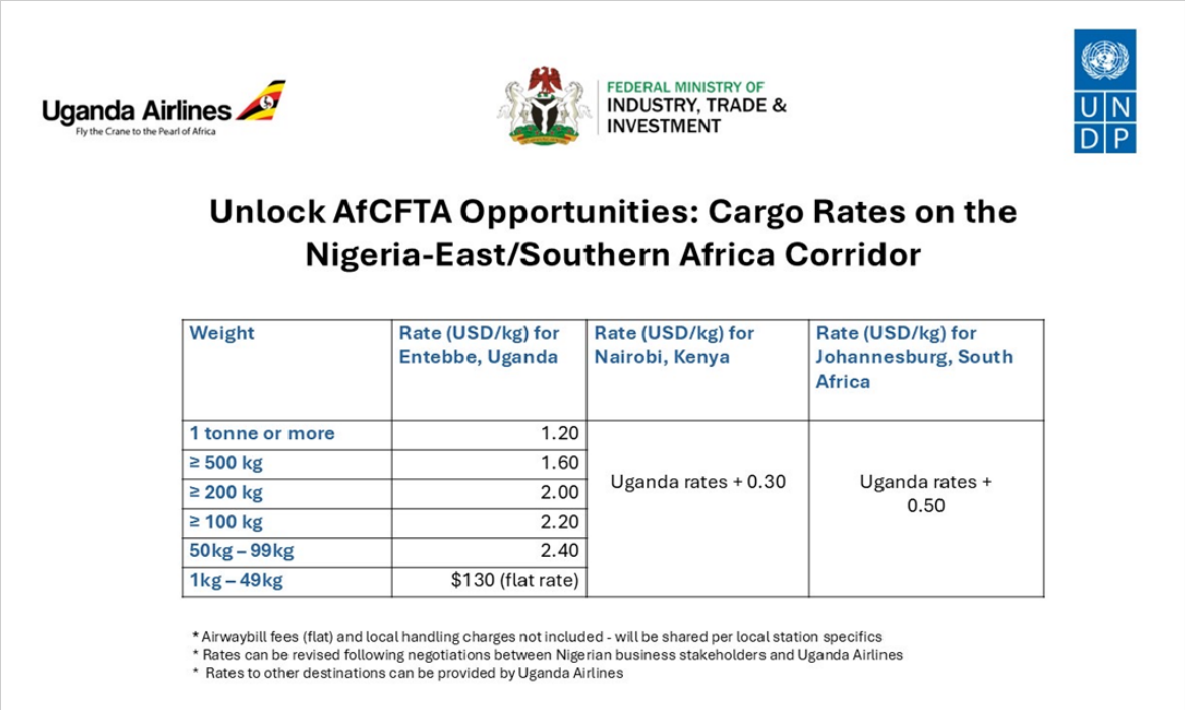
The Nigerian negotiating position was framed by consultations led by the Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment (FMITI) through Hajara Usman, Deputy Director, Commodities and Export Department, with Olufemi Boyede and Temi Oluokun of the Office of the Honourable Minister.
The FMITI team was supported by the Nigerian Export Promotion Council, represented by Evelyn Obidike, Director, Policy & Strategy (retired) and Peter Njoku, Deputy Director, Market Access Development, alongside the Nigerian Shippers' Council represented by Celestine Akujobi, Director, Consumer Affairs (retired) and Margaret Ogbonna, Director, Regulatory Services.

Participating groups included the Nigerian Chamber of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture, especially through the Women's Chamber and the Ogun State Chamber. Other groups included the Nigerian Association of Small Scale Industrialists, the Nigerian Association of Small and Medium Enterprises, Organisation of Women in International Trade (Nigeria Chapter), the Edo Licensed Exporters' Association, the Women in Processing Association, and the Shea Butter Women Association of Nigeria. Over 40 individual businesses, such as Starlink Global Ideal Limited, also contributed to this process. Critically, the aggregation of perspectives from businesses and business associations gave Nigerian exporters a negotiating position that no individual MSME could have achieved.

The consultations provided insights into trade flows, trends, and opportunities as well as ideal cargo

rates that would unlock increased exports from Nigeria. Nigerian businesses prioritised three destinations, Uganda, Kenya, and South Africa, that are both destination markets and hubs from which goods can be further distributed into East and Southern Africa. Importantly, the interests of micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) were central to formulating Nigeria's position.

Insights from the curated dataset and consultations with the private sector underpinned the Nigeria counterproposal for tiered flat-rate pricing, alongside a special rate for minimum consignments of 50. Uganda Airlines agreed to the Nigerian counteroffer as shown in the image below.



Uganda Airlines
Fly the Crane to the Pearl of Africa

FEDERAL MINISTRY OF INDUSTRY, TRADE & INVESTMENT

UNDP

Unlock AfCFTA Opportunities: Cargo Rates on the Nigeria-East/Southern Africa Corridor

Weight	Rate (USD/kg) for Entebbe, Uganda	Rate (USD/kg) for Nairobi, Kenya	Rate (USD/kg) for Johannesburg, South Africa
1 tonne or more	1.20	Uganda rates + 0.30	Uganda rates + 0.50
≥ 500 kg	1.60		
≥ 200 kg	2.00		
≥ 100 kg	2.20		
50kg – 99kg	2.40		
1kg – 49kg	$130 (flat rate)		

* Airwaybill fees (flat) and local handling charges not included - will be shared per local station specifics
* Rates can be revised following negotiations between Nigerian business stakeholders and Uganda Airlines
* Rates to other destinations can be provided by Uganda Airlines

Figure 1: Rebated rates offered by Uganda Airlines to Nigerian Businesses in 2025

The Corridor was operationalised with the support of an inter-ministerial team comprising the following:

The Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment

Ambassador Nura Abba Rimi, Permanent Secretary, Zulaikha Abdullahi, Deputy Director, and Emeka Okafor, Principal Commercial Officer, Trade Department, with support of Patience Okala, Special Advisor to the Honourable Minister, Nwando Ajene, Special Advisor to the Honourable Minister on Strategy and Communications, Olayombo Ade-Ojo, Senior Special Assistant to the Honourable Minister on Trade Facilitation, and Ayo Thomas, Senior Special Assistant to the Honourable Minister.

The Federal Ministry of Aviation and Aerospace Development

Festus Keyamo SAN, Honourable Minister and Olubunmi Kuku, Managing Director, Federal Airports Authority of Nigeria.

The Federal Ministry of Aviation and Aerospace Development

Bashir Adeniyi, Comptroller General and Nafiu Isiyaku, Assistant Comptroller General.

[2] Africa Day commemorates the establishment of the Organisation of African Unity, now the African Union, in 1963.

The collaborative approach to establishing this corridor is a successful demonstration of the whole-of-economy approach that underpins Nigeria's implementation of the AfCFTA.

Honourable Minister, Industry, Trade and Investment, Dr. Jumoke Oduwole MFR at the Flag-Off of the Nigeria-East/Southern Africa Air Cargo Corridor

The corridor was officially flagged off on Africa Day, 25 May 2025, by FMITI in collaboration with the Federal Ministry of Aviation and Aerospace Development, the Federal Airports Authority of Nigeria, and the Nigeria Customs Service, with the support of UNDP.

Deputy Head of Mission and Chargé d'Affaires, Uganda High Commission, Ambassador Philip Odida (holding microphone), with the Comptroller- General, Nigeria Customs Service, alongside Representatives of the Five Exporting Businesses and Freight Forwarders watch as cargo is loaded

Loading of cargo on the Inaugural Flight

Uganda Airlines Aircraft that carried the inaugural consignment on the Nigeria-East/Southern Africa Air Cargo Corridor

The inaugural consignment from Abuja was carried by five women-owned and led Nigerian businesses exporting agro-processed products, clothing and textiles to Kenya:

Table 2: The Five Women-Owned and Led Nigerian Businesses that Launched the Corridor

Business	Principal	Product
Avila Naturalle Ltd	Dr. Temitope Mayegun	Black Soap
Macariusville Dates and Foods Ltd	Vivyen Ayodele-Bamisaye	Date and Tigernut Mixed Powder, Date Powder
Bio-Pulse Limited	Ifeoma Ogbukagu	Bean Flour, Peas Flour, Finger Millet Flour
Lelook Nigeria Ltd	Chief Mrs. Chinwe Ezenwa	Leather bags, Garments, Apparel
Shea Origin Ltd	Mobola Sagoe	Shea butter products

The launch of this corridor also commenced the substantive implementation of the AfCFTA preferential tariff arrangements in Nigeria. In April 2025, Nigeria gazetted the AfCFTA Provisional Schedule of Tariff Concessions to progressively reduce tariffs applicable on made-in-Africa goods. Nigerian goods also became eligible to receive similar reduced (and eventually duty free) treatment in other AfCFTA State Parties that also have gazetted AfCFTA tariffs. Accordingly, at the flag-off ceremony, the Nigeria Customs Service, as the Designated Competent Authority issued AfCFTA Certificates of Origin to the five exporting businesses. These Certificates confirmed that their goods qualify as originating in an AfCFTA State Party. Upon arrival in Nairobi, Kenya on 26 May 2025, the goods received preferential tariff treatment.

Presentation of AfCFTA Certificates of Origin to Macariusville Dates and Food Ltd and Bio Pulse Limited

Presentation of the AfCFTA Certificate of Origin to LeLook Limited

The Honourable Minster, Industry Trade and Investment with the Exporting Businesses, UNDP Resident Representative Nigeria and UNDP Regional AfCFTA Specialist, and the Deputy Head of Mission and Chargé d'Affaires, Uganda High Commission, Nigeria

The Honourable Minister, Industry Trade and Investment, Dr. Jumoke Oduwole with the Comptroller-General, Nigeria Customs Service briefing the press and other stakeholders at the launch of the Nigeria-East/Southern Africa Air Cargo Corridor

This convergence of reduced tariffs and lower cargo rates has unlocked tremendous opportunities for Nigerian exporters to the African market. One year after, key lessons are highlighted in Section C below.

C Key Lessons

One year after the flag-off, the corridor offers a set of lessons for Nigeria's continuing AfCFTA implementation and for other African countries pursuing similar arrangements.

1. Reducing The Cost of Cargo Directly Contributes To Increased Value And Volume Of Export Shipments

Before the operationalisation of the corridor, the cost of moving Nigerian goods to East and Southern Africa by air was a prohibitive barrier to competitively priced exports. Consultations with businesses and business associations identified a significant share of exporters paying between $5-$7 per kg to export goods, with some businesses paying above $10 per kg.

To illustrate, an exporter shipping 100 kg of food products with other commercial carriers to Nairobi, Kenya typically paid a cargo cost of between $500-$1,000. When the Uganda Airlines arrangement is used, this cost is reduced to $250.

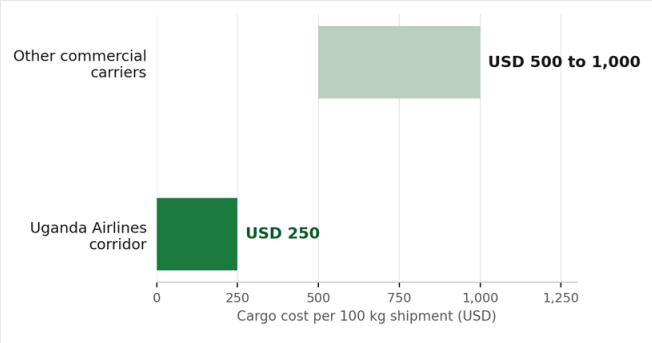


Figure 2: Comparative cost for a 100 kg shipment of food products from Nigeria to Nairobi, Kenya using Uganda Airlines and other commercial carriers

Exporters who have used the corridor report meaningful cost reductions. In May 2026, one exporter operating in the textile sector reported export volumes of up to 1,000 metric tonnes to Kenya since May 2025, amounting to approximately $100,000 in export revenue. This business expects to further increase its volume of exports to Kenya by 50% in the near term.

$100,000 export revenue

by a single textile exporter, facilitated by the corridor in under 12 months

50%

Further projected increase in this exporter's volumes to Kenya

Other businesses reported significant benefits accruing from this corridor:

> **"I have since shipped bags, garments, and apparel directly to Kenya and Uganda, and I am now planning to export to South Africa. My target is to exceed 1,000 kg monthly. This arrangement has genuinely opened a new door for me."**
>
> — Chief Chinwe Ezenwa, Lelook Nigeria Ltd

> **"My pricing was not competitive in the Kenya market before because of the logistics cost. With the reduced rate, I have used the arrangement twice to Kenya. I want to see more initiatives like this so MSMEs can sell more and grow, and I especially appreciate that it is a transparent process."**
>
> — Dr. Temitope Mayegun, Avila Naturalle Ltd

Logistics service providers facilitating use of the corridor also affirm its benefits to Nigerian exporters:

> **"The tiered rate arrangement has driven a 70% reduction in cargo costs compared to other airlines, making it far cheaper for MSMEs. Since May 2025, we've seen an increase of approximately 40% in export volumes. The main products exported are agro-processed products, bags, clothes, and medical equipment from Lagos and Abuja into Kenya and South Africa. Some exports have gone to Uganda as well. We also see more micro and small businesses using the corridor. This arrangement needs to be sustained in the long-term so smaller exporters can rely on it consistently."**
>
> — March 31st Logistics Ltd, Freight Forwarder for Uganda Airlines

70%

reduction in cargo costs compared with other airlines

40%

increase in export volumes since May 2025

Other businesses reported significant benefits accruing from this corridor:

> **"The strength of this initiative is that it makes MSMEs competitive and expands their reach into new markets."**
>
> — Kola Awe, Chairman, The Nigerian Association of Chambers of Commerce, Industry, Mines and Agriculture Export Group and Chief Executive of XPT Group of Companies

The experience of these businesses demonstrates the value of the corridor as a practical instrument for expanding Nigerian exports under the AfCFTA. As cargo costs fall, Nigerian MSMEs can enter new markets, and position their products in a price-competitive manner. Also, they can move away from using informal and high-risk channels to move their goods to other African markets. The corridor also delivers cargo to destinations typically within 24 hours and accommodates a wide range of cargo sizes through its tiered structure.

2 A Whole-Of-Government Approach And Collaboration With The Private Sector Ensured Success

The corridor was delivered through coordinated action across the Federal Government of Nigeria. FMITI led efforts, with the support of other government institutions as set out below.

Table 3: Nigerian Government Institutions that Facilitated the Operationalisation of the Nigeria – East/Southern Africa Air Cargo Corridor

Institution	Mandate
Federal Ministry of Industry, Trade and Investment	Lead ministry for trade and investment policy, including AfCFTA implementation
Nigerian Export Promotion Council	Promotion and development of Nigerian non-oil exports
Federal Ministry of Aviation and Aerospace Development	Policy and regulation of the aviation and aerospace sector
Federal Airports Authority of Nigeria	Management and operation of Nigerian airports
Nigeria Customs Service	Trade facilitation at borders and issuance of AfCFTA Certificates of Origin
Nigerian Shippers' Council	Economic regulation of the shipping sector and protection of shippers' interests

This approach reflects the model of the AfCFTA Central Coordination Committee, inaugurated in March 2025, which brings together over twenty public and private stakeholder institutions to drive Nigeria's AfCFTA implementation. The corridor is a practical demonstration of the effectiveness of the whole-of-economy structure spearheaded by FMITI for trade facilitation.

Importantly, this exercise better positions Nigerian businesses and business associations to cooperate among themselves and with government for the achievement of common trade-related interests, including potential future negotiations for the review of cargo rates as market dynamics evolve.

3. Strategic Results-Oriented Collaboration with Development Partners Enables Results

The UNDP Regional Bureau for Africa identified the opportunity with Uganda Airlines and brought it to the attention of the Honourable Minister of Industry, Trade and Investment. UNDP convened the parties, provided technical advisory services to the Federal Government, as well as to Nigerian businesses and business associations in preparation for the negotiations, in addition to facilitating the negotiations process.
This form of collaboration, anchored in technical support to government and to business and structured around a clearly defined commercial outcome for AfCFTA implementation and specifically for Nigeria's traders, will be expanded with other development partners.

4 Tariff Reduction and Lower Logistics Costs Incentivise Exports, But Standards Compliance and Non-Tariff Barriers Are Priority Challenges To Be Addressed

AfCFTA tariff rates are applied by countries that have gazetted Schedules of Tariff Concessions. Under the Agreement, tariffs on made-in-Africa goods are progressively reduced to zero, beginning with 90 per cent of tariff lines. Nigeria's gazetting of the Provisional Schedule of Tariff Concessions in April 2025 materially reduced the duties payable on Nigerian goods entering Kenya and South Africa, as shown in the table below:

Table 4: Selected Tariff Changes for Nigerian Exports pre and post gazetting of AfCFTA Schedules of Tariff Concessions in Destination Markets[5]

Product	Uganda (Pre)	Uganda (Post 2025)	Kenya (Pre)	Kenya (Post 2025)	S. Africa (Pre)	S. Africa (Post 2025)
Leather bags	25%	**12.5%**	25%	**12.5%**	30%	**15%**
Garments	25%	**12.5%**	25%	**12.5%**	45%	**22.5%**
Dates	25%	**12.5%**	25%	**12.5%**	0%	**0%**

[3] Under the AfCFTA, tariffs are progressively reduced to zero. For Category A products, the phase-down period is 10 years for Least Developed Countries and 5 years for non-Least Developed Countries. See UNCTAD (2020), DESIGNING TRADE LIBERALIZATION IN AFRICA: MODALITIES FOR TARIFF NEGOTIATIONS TOWARDS AN AFRICAN CONTINENTAL FREE TRADE AREA via https://unctad.org/system/files/official-document/ditctncd2019d4_en.pdf
[4] The principle of reciprocity in the AfCFTA Agreement requires State Parties to gazette AfCFTA tariffs in order for preferential tariffs to be applied to their goods when exported to other AfCFTA State Parties. Preferential tariffs are applied only by countries that have concluded the gazetting process. For a full list of African countries that have gazetted AfCFTA tariffs, consult the AfCFTA Secretariat for the most recent information.
[5] Source: AfCFTA e-tariff book. https://qaafcfta.z6.web.core.windows.net/mapsearch

Product	Uganda (Pre)	Uganda (Post 2025)	Kenya (Pre)	Kenya (Post 2025)	S. Africa (Pre)	S. Africa (Post 2025)
Soap	25%	**12.5%**	25%	**12.5%**	20%	**10%**
Other agricultural products	0%	**0%**	0%	**0%**	0%	**0%**
Flour	25%	**12.5%**	25%	**12.5%**	0%	**0%**
Shea Butter	10%	**5%**	10%	**5%**	10%	**0%**

Note: Pre-AfCFTA rates reflect World Trade Organisation Most Favoured Nation rates that precede the liberalisation of tariffs under the AfCFTA Agreement.

While the reduction in tariff and cargo rates are beneficial to Nigerian exporters, standards and certification requirements remain a constraint.

> **"The freight cost was genuinely reduced, and that's a huge breakthrough for me as an exporter. But it was expensive to obtain the relevant certification for our products in Kenya. We need harmonisation of standards across African countries. Nonetheless, I am definitely going to leverage the reduced rates again."**
>
> — Cecilia Ifeoma Ogbukagu, Bio Pulse Ltd

> **"Many MSMEs are unaware of the compliance requirements to export from Nigeria. They are eager to use this reduced rate, but they require support to understand and complete trade formalities."**
>
> — March 31st Logistics Ltd, Freight Forwarder for Uganda Airlines

This corridor also highlights specific products that could benefit from standards harmonisation efforts in the AfCFTA market. FMITI, in collaboration with the relevant Ministries, Departments and Agencies, and through continental policy and regulatory platforms and bilateral channels, continues to engage partner countries on standards harmonisation and trade facilitation for Nigerian exporters.

Conclusion

Nigerian businesses interested in exporting using this arrangement may contact licensed freight forwarders or directly take their consignments to the relevant airline desks in Lagos and request the special rate.

For more information, contact:

Uganda Airlines:

Airport Office, Murtala Muhammed International Airport, Lagos.
Telephone: +234 9169997343.
Email: reservations@ugandairlines.com.

RwandAir:

Airport Office, Murtala Muhammed International Airport, Lagos.
Telephone: +250738306074/ +250780967285.
Email: cargo@rwandair.com / cargobooking@rwandair.com.

For assistance with the completion of trade formalities in Nigeria and in destination markets, businesses should visit the offices and/or website of the Nigeria Export Promotion Council via https://nepc.gov.ng/ereg/exporter and the Nigeria AfCFTA Coordination Office via www.ngrafcfta.gov.ng. AfCFTA Certificates of Origin can be processed through the Nigeria Customs Service via coo.nigeriatradehub.gov.ng.

For a holistic understanding of how to export under the AfCFTA from Nigeria, a useful resource is the "AfCFTA Simplified – The ABCs of Doing Business Under the AfCFTA in Nigeria (Vol.1)" available via https://canva.link/abcseries.

FMITI remains committed to ensuring that Nigerian businesses successfully navigate and thrive in the AfCFTA market. FMITI, through the AfCFTA Central Coordination Committee and its constituent Ministries, Departments and Agencies, alongside the Nigeria AfCFTA Coordination Office will continue to mobilise Nigerian exporters to utilise the air cargo corridor.

Annexes

Annex

Annex 1: AfCFTA Implementation Milestones in Nigeria (2025)

Month	Milestone
January 2025	Hosted the Secretary General of the AfCFTA Secretariat along with Nigerian Digital Operators.
February 2025	Appointed as Co-Champion of the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade (alongside Kenya and South Africa) by the African Union Assembly of Heads of State and Government. Mr. President received the commendation of the African Union Assembly of Heads of State and Government for advancing digital trade in Africa.
March 2025	Inaugurated the AfCFTA Central Coordination Committee (CCC) that establishes a whole-of-economy structure bringing together over twenty key public and private stakeholder institutions.
April 2025	Gazetted Nigeria's Provisional Schedule of Tariff Concessions for Trade in Goods. Conducted the first-ever national mapping of digital services, generating a directory of over 200 digital service firms operating in 17 sectors.
May 2025	Won hosting rights for the second edition of the AfCFTA Digital Forum. Launched a dedicated Exports Air Cargo Corridor to East and Southern Africa in partnership with Uganda Airlines and UNDP. Published a Market Intelligence Tool covering cosmetics, agro-processed products, and textiles across 13 East and Southern African markets, in collaboration with UNDP.
September 2025	Won the bid to host the Intra-African Trade Fair 2027 and Creative Africa Nexus 2026.
October 2025	Submitted Nigeria's Schedule of Specific Commitments for Trade in Services to ECOWAS Commission. Convened the first AfCFTA Regional Digital Market Access and Regulators' Roundtable with Egypt, Ghana, Kenya, Rwanda and South Africa and established a Regional Digital Trade Regulators' Working Group. Won the bid to host the 2026 meeting of the AfCFTA Council of Ministers.
November 2025	Approved the ratification of the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade. Convened the AfCFTA Public Sector, Private Sector and Press (P3) Summit. Launched a nationwide AfCFTA Sensitisation and Consultation Campaign. Published the National Action Plan Framework of the AfCFTA Central Coordination Committee.
December	Preparation of AfCFTA Knowledge Products.

Source: Nigeria AfCFTA Achievements Report 2025